

CLEMATIS

Among the climbers, clematis are unsurpassed in their long period of flowering (with species flowering in almost every month of the year), the variety of flower shapes and colors, and their tolerance of almost any aspect and climate. Some spring-flowering species and cultivars are vigorous and excellent for rapidly covering buildings, old trees, and pergolas. Other, less rampant cultivars display often large, exquisite blooms from early summer to fall in almost every color. Flower colors may vary according to your climatic conditions; in general, the warmer the climate, the darker the flowers are likely to be.

Clematis look attractive when trained on walls or trellises and when grown in association with other climbers, trees, or shrubs, treating them as hosts. Less vigorous cultivars may also be left unsupported to scramble at ground level, where their flowers will be clearly visible.

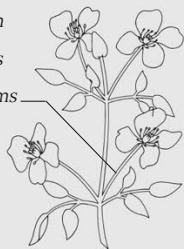
The various types of clematis (see the Plant Dictionary) may be divided into 3 groups, each of which has different pruning requirements. Incorrect pruning may result in cutting out the stems that will produce flowers in the current season, so the following guidelines should be followed closely.

Group 1

Early-flowering species, Early small-flowered cultivars, Alpina, Macropetala, and Montana types

Flower stems are produced direct from the previous season's ripened stems. Prune after flowering to allow new growth to be produced and ripened for the next season. Remove dead or damaged stems and cut back other shoots that have outgrown their allotted space.

Flower stem direct from the previous season's ripened stems



Current season's stems have one flower and are 6-18in (15-45cm) long

Discarded previous season's old flower stem

Discarded previous season's leaves



Group 2

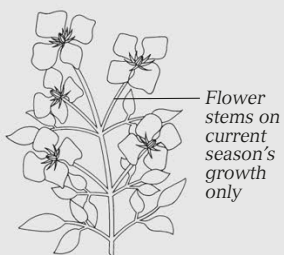
Early large-flowered cultivars

Flowers are produced on short, current season's stems, so prune before new growth starts, in early spring. Remove dead or damaged stems and cut back all others to where strong, leaf-axil buds are visible. (These buds will produce the first crop of flowers.)

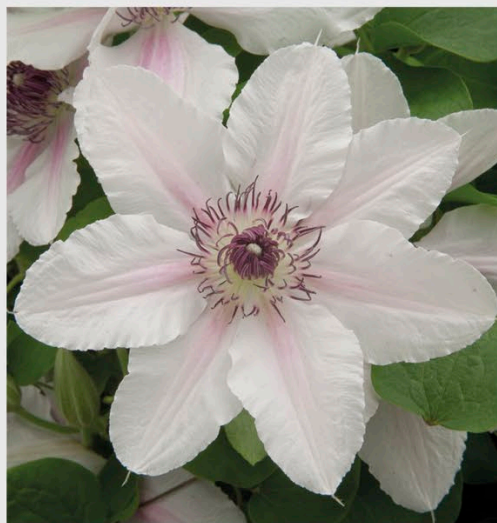
Group 3

Late large-flowered cultivars, Late small-flowered cultivars, Late-flowering species and Herbaceous types

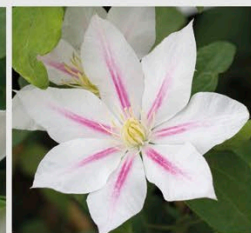
Flowers are produced on the current season's growth only, so prune before new growth commences, in early spring. Remove all of the previous season's stems down to a pair of strong, leaf-axil buds, 6-12in (15-30cm) above the soil (though Herbaceous types can be cleared to ground level).



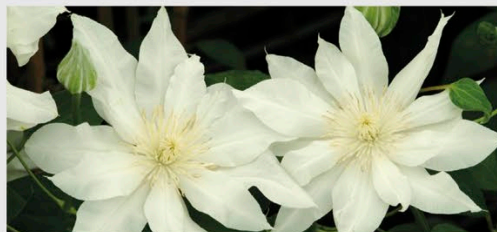
Flower stems on current season's growth only



C. THE COUNTESS OF WESSEX ('Evipo073') [group 2]



C. 'Andromeda' [group 2]



C. ARCTIC QUEEN ('Evitwo') [group 2]



C. 'White Columbine' [group 1]



C. armandii [group 1]



C. 'Guernsey Cream' [group 2]

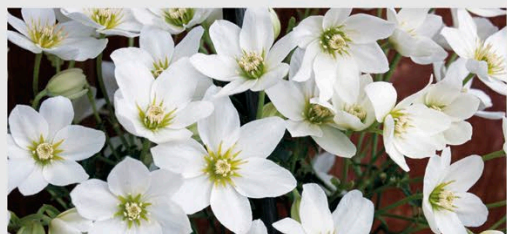
C. x cartmanii 'Avalanche' [group 1]



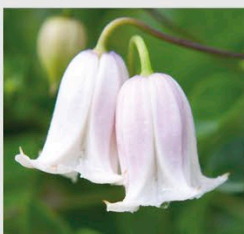
C. 'Early Sensation' [group 1]



C. montana [group 1]



C. x cartmanii 'Joe' [group 1]



C. 'Kaiu' [group 3]